

Common Jointing Defects & How to Avoid Them

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The Power Quality Team sees the same joint defects repeat across sites, and almost all of them are avoidable with basic discipline. Use this card in toolbox talks: know the defect, know the cause, build the habit that prevents it.

DEFECT	TYPICAL CAUSE	HOW TO AVOID IT
Moisture ingress	Jointing in damp conditions or over wet surfaces	Enclose the area, dry all surfaces and re-verify before closing the joint
Surface contamination	Dust, oil or handling marks on insulation	Clean immediately before application; keep accessory packaging closed until use
Poor conductor crimp	Wrong die or too few crimps	Use the correct die and crimp count; inspect every crimp
Screen / semi-con damage	Careless cutting during preparation	Clean cuts only, no nicks; follow the preparation dimensions exactly
Voids in insulation	Air trapped during insulation build-up	Apply per instruction and roll out trapped air layer by layer
Earth / screen discontinuity	Bonding step missed	Verify metallic screen and earth continuity across the joint
Wrong / mismatched kit	Components picked without checking	Confirm the kit against cable type, size and voltage class before starting

Remember: If a surface gets wet or dirty, or anything does not match the instruction: stop, correct it, and re-verify. When in doubt, call the Power Quality Team before closing the joint.